

# NEWSLETTER



**BREAD OF LIFE**  
FEED • SHELTER • EMPOWER

**AUGUST 2026**

Providing Hope. Restoring Lives. Building Community.  
Serving the Greater Kennebec County Area Since 1984

“

**Success is not final;  
Failure is not fatal;  
It is the courage to  
continue that counts.**

Winston Churchill

”

## ORGANIZATION SNAPSHOT

In July -

We served over **4,465 meals.**

Our shelters helped **68** individuals in emergent situations find a safe landing.

**15** people moved into housing from our shelters.

**This multiplied = HOPE**

## FROM THE EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR

In a city with so many needs, providing food, shelter, and housing is about more than meeting basic necessities—it is about creating a foundation for stability, dignity, and hope.

Every meal served, every safe night provided, and every person supported in finding a home represents an opportunity to make a meaningful difference in someone's life. These services remind us that no one should have to face hardship alone, and that our community is strongest when we care for one another.

The challenges are significant, but so is the impact we can make together. Through the generosity of our supporters, the dedication of our staff and volunteers, and the resilience of the people we serve, we are helping create a city where everyone has a place to turn and a chance to move forward.

Thank you for being part of that work. Your support is helping transform immediate needs into pathways toward greater stability and a stronger community for all.

~Victoria Abbott



**PHOTO FROM STAFF DAY  
2026**

# HIGHLIGHT: OUR SOUP KITCHEN



Since 1984, the Bread of Life soup kitchen has been providing wholesome meals accompanied by a smile to countless individuals. It is our mission to welcome, feed, and support every individual with respect. The kitchen is blessed with staff and volunteers alike. We love and greatly appreciate our community's involvement!

Daily, many souls are warmed with freshly made meals averaging **65 breakfasts and 110 lunches**. The atmosphere present at the Bread of Life soup kitchen encompasses kindness and dignity. Inside the soup kitchen walls, you will find a diner-style atmosphere that offers a safe space for sharing. Many conversations are had amongst the tables as the individuals present share their life stories with one another.

## MEET OUR COOK:



Willie started volunteering in our soup kitchen in 2024 and joined us as a staff member in 2025. Willie is dedicated to serving home-cooked meals to our patrons and puts his heart into every meal!

## HOW CAN YOU HELP?

There are multiple ways to get involved!

Volunteering, engaging in community partnerships, and financial support are all valuable pillars for Bread of Life! Your involvement helps change lives, so please reach out today and let us know how you would like to be a part of making a beautiful difference in our community!

[MAINEBREADOFLIFE.ORG](https://mainebreadoflife.org)